

StrapBottle

The water bottle with a built-in strap. Hands free, always.

What It Is

StrapBottle is a reusable water bottle with a retractable carry strap built directly into the body. The user pulls the strap out, throws it over a shoulder, and walks hands-free; when not needed, it tucks back in flush with the bottle. It is a small, obvious upgrade to a product millions of people already buy every day, which makes it easy to explain and easy to sell to a massive existing market.

How It Makes Money

A classic e-commerce physical-product play. You source the bottle cheaply from a manufacturer, brand it, and sell direct-to-consumer at a premium markup through your own Shopify store and marketplaces. Buyers are gym-goers, hikers, commuters, students, festival/travel crowds, and parents. Secondary revenue comes from color variants, accessory straps, bundles (2-packs), and wholesale to gyms, yoga studios, and corporate-gift buyers.

Startup Costs

- Product samples from 3-4 Alibaba suppliers: \$150-\$400
- First inventory order (500 units): Alibaba unit cost **\$3.50-\$6.50/bottle** = \$1,750-\$3,250
- Custom logo/branding + mold or print setup fee: \$300-\$1,200 (often waived above MOQ)
- Sea freight + duties on first order: \$400-\$900
- Shopify + apps (3 months): \$100-\$300
- Product photography and short demo video: \$300-\$1,000 (or DIY)
- Paid-ad test budget: \$1,500-\$3,000
- Logo, packaging design, LLC: \$500-\$1,500

Realistic launch budget: \$5,000-\$9,000.

The Numbers

- Landed cost per unit (product + freight + duty): **\$5-\$8**
- Sell price: **\$29-\$39** retail
- Profit per unit before ad spend: **\$21-\$33**; after blended ad cost (~\$10-\$14 CAC) net **\$10-\$20/unit**
- At 800-1,500 units/month: **\$8,000-\$30,000/month net profit** once ad creative is dialed in
- Wholesale tier: sell at \$14-\$18/unit in cases of 50 to gyms/retailers for volume at thinner margin
- Realistic monthly projection (months 3-9): scale from \$3K to \$25K+/month net as winning ad creatives compound.

How To Start

1. Order samples from several Alibaba bottle manufacturers and personally test the strap mechanism, leak-proofing, and feel.
2. Pick the best supplier, negotiate a 500-unit branded first order, and confirm packaging and lead time.
3. Build a clean one-product Shopify store focused entirely on the hands-free benefit.

4. Shoot 3-5 short vertical demo videos showing the pull-out strap in real situations (gym, hike, commute).
5. Launch TikTok and Meta ads with a \$50-\$80/day test budget, killing losers and scaling winners fast.
6. Fulfill from home or a 3PL; gather reviews and user-generated content from early buyers.
7. Reinvest profit into more creative and a wholesale outreach push to gyms and studios.

Where To Get Customers

- TikTok and Instagram Reels (organic + paid) showing the strap in action
- Meta and TikTok paid ads with UGC-style demo creatives
- Influencer seeding to fitness, hiking, and travel creators
- Amazon listing for high-intent search traffic
- Wholesale outreach to gyms, yoga studios, CrossFit boxes, and corporate-gift buyers
- Google Shopping ads on "hands-free water bottle"

Pro Tips

- Win on the demo, not the description. The strap pulling out is a 3-second visual hook; lead every ad with that single motion.
- Order a slightly higher MOQ to unlock free custom branding and a lower per-unit cost. Suppliers routinely waive setup fees above 500-1,000 units.
- Build a 2-pack and "his/hers" color bundle to lift average order value. The marginal cost is tiny but it can raise AOV 40-60%.